



FIELD INSPECTOR — FULL JOB DESCRIPTION

Company: Atlas Crest LLC

Engagement: Independent contractor (1099), assignment by assignment

Service area: Locations where Atlas Crest has active client demand, based on each inspector's approved territory and current route volume

Work type: Residential property field inspections. Commercial assignments are not part of this role today; if Atlas Crest adds commercial work later, it would be offered separately to qualified inspectors under its own terms.

Purpose of the role

Atlas Crest completes property inspections ordered for insurance and loss-control purposes. The inspector visits the assigned property, documents observable conditions, takes required photographs and measurements, records accurate answers in the Company-designated inspection system, and submits the completed assignment for Atlas Crest quality review.

This is field-inspection work only. It does not include premium audits, insurance sales, coverage advice, claims decisions, valuation opinions, or authority to speak for an insurance carrier or inspection service provider beyond the limited identification wording expressly authorized for a particular assignment.

What an inspector does

For each assignment the inspector accepts, the inspector will:

- Review the address, inspection type, due date, fee, access notes, and required scope before accepting.
- Contact the property contact when an appointment or access coordination is required.
- Travel to the property using the inspector's own vehicle.
- Use only the badge, identification wording, verification procedure, and door material Atlas Crest designates for that assignment. Some clients require an inspector to identify using the client's name or to state that the visit is on behalf of the carrier.
- Follow the assignment-specific checklist in the inspection system or other workflow identified in the assignment.
- Take clear, current, location-specific photographs of required areas and conditions.
- Photograph the address and the reason for any inaccessible or obstructed item.
- Measure exterior walls or other required features with a tape or measuring wheel.
- Record only what the inspector personally observes or what an authorized contact states.
- Submit the assignment through the designated system or method by the due date.
- Respond promptly to Atlas Crest quality-review questions and correct an inspector-caused omission within the stated correction window, which is normally 24 hours.
- Immediately leave and notify Atlas Crest if the property presents a safety concern.

Most entry-level assignments are exterior residential inspections. Some assignments include scheduled interior access or a broader checklist. The offer will identify the inspection type before the inspector accepts it.

What an inspector does not do

An inspector will not:

- Climb onto a roof, use a ladder, force a gate, climb a fence, or enter an unsafe area.
- Enter a dwelling or restricted area without permission and an assignment requiring access.
- Guess, stage, reuse, edit deceptively, or submit photographs taken by another person.
- Give insurance, premium, underwriting, claims, repair, or coverage advice.



- Promise an outcome or claim employee, agent, producer, adjuster, auditor, or other authority beyond the narrow assignment-specific identification Atlas Crest authorizes.
- Contact Atlas Crest's clients unless Atlas Crest gives written direction for a specific need.
- Share property information, photographs, client information, system access, or training material.
- Advertise, solicit, quote, recommend, refer, sell, or offer any outside product or service during an assignment, or later use an assignment contact or relationship for marketing or lead generation.
- Distribute or display an outside business card, flyer, QR code, referral link, badge, uniform, logo, or other promotional material while performing or communicating about an assignment.
- Delegate an accepted assignment or bring a helper without Atlas Crest's prior written consent.
- Perform or access any premium-audit work.

How assignments are offered

Assignments or route bundles are offered through Atlas Crest with the available information, including location, inspection type, due date, and fee. The inspector may accept or decline an offer. No minimum number of assignments or amount of income is guaranteed. An offer that is not accepted by its expiration time may be offered to someone else. Silence is not acceptance. Once an inspector accepts an assignment, the inspector is responsible for meeting its due date or notifying Atlas Crest as soon as a delay or access problem becomes known.

The inspector generally controls the order of stops and the manner of travel, subject to any appointment window, property-access restriction, due date, safety rule, and required deliverable.

Atlas Crest records whether offers are accepted, declined, or allowed to expire. Atlas Crest also maintains an internal reliability profile using response time, completion of accepted work, timeliness, submission quality, correction history, and communication. Declining an offer is not a breach of the contractor relationship; the history is used for capacity planning, territory matching, quality management, and future assignment decisions.

Quality standard

Every submission is reviewed before delivery to a client. Work must be accurate, complete, legible, current, and tied to the correct property. Normal quality review may require an answer, additional photograph, or return visit.

If a return visit is required because the inspector missed a required item or submitted an unusable image, the correction is part of the original assignment. If the client changes or adds scope after the original work was properly completed, Atlas Crest will treat the added work as a new or adjusted assignment.

Compensation and expenses

- Compensation is the fee displayed on the accepted assignment or route offer.
- Compensation is per assignment, not hourly.
- Atlas Crest pays weekly for work that has been submitted and approved through quality review.
- Work pending an inspector correction is paid after the correction is accepted.
- The inspector pays their own vehicle, fuel, mileage, phone, data, equipment, taxes, and other operating expenses unless Atlas Crest agrees otherwise in writing for a specific assignment.
- Atlas Crest does not guarantee assignment volume, hours, routes, or income.
- Payment is made by ACH through Found. A completed IRS Form W-9 and a completed Found payment profile are required before payment.



Required qualifications and equipment

- At least 18 years old and legally authorized to work in the United States.
- Valid driver's license, reliable vehicle, and required auto insurance.
- Smartphone with a working camera, data service, location services, and a secure screen lock.
- Extension pole with a secure phone mount for ground-based roof photographs.
- Tape measure or measuring wheel.
- Ability to walk around properties outdoors in daylight and the ordinary weather conditions of the inspector's approved service area.
- Ability to communicate professionally with occupants and business contacts.
- Ability to follow a detailed checklist and protect confidential information.
- Successful completion of the required background-screening and Atlas Crest certification steps before the first live assignment.

Confidentiality and data security

Names, addresses, phone numbers, policy-related information, photographs, measurements, inspection findings, client identities, pricing, software, and training material are confidential. Assignment information may be used only to complete Atlas Crest work and may be stored or transmitted only through approved channels.

The inspector must keep the work device locked, prevent others from viewing or using Company systems, report a lost device or suspected disclosure immediately, and delete local assignment material when Atlas Crest confirms receipt or otherwise instructs.

Screening, onboarding, and first assignment

After confirming interest, a candidate receives the complete onboarding packet. Before live work, Atlas Crest must have all required signed agreements, a completed W-9, Found payment setup, driver's-license and auto-insurance verification, background-screening clearance, successful completion of Atlas Crest training and a practice inspection, and confirmation of any client-required clearance, badge, or credential.

The first live assignment is closely reviewed. Continued offers depend on current route volume, client eligibility, territory fit, and the inspector's reliability profile, including response time, completion, timeliness, quality, corrections, and communication.

Physical and safety conditions

The work involves driving, standing, walking on grass and uneven ground, bending, using a phone and measuring equipment, and working outdoors. Inspectors do not climb roofs or ladders. A person who needs a reasonable modification to complete an application or discuss the work should contact Atlas Crest.

Acknowledgment

I received and read this job description. I understand that it describes assignment-based independent-contractor work and does not itself guarantee work or create an employment relationship. The signed Independent Contractor Agreement controls if it conflicts with this description.

Inspector name: _____

Signature: _____ **Date:** _____



FIELD INSPECTOR APPLICATION

Atlas Crest LLC — independent-contractor field inspection services

BEFORE YOU FILL THIS OUT

Complete this after reading the Full Job Description and deciding you want to move forward. This application does not guarantee engagement or assignments. Do not put a Social Security number, bank account number, or other tax information on this form.

Contact information

Full legal name: _____

Name you go by: _____ Email: _____

Home address: _____

City / State / ZIP: _____

Cell phone: _____

Can it receive texts? Yes No

Are you at least 18 and legally authorized to work in the United States? Yes No

Driving and vehicle

Do you have a current driver's license? Yes No

License state: _____ Expiration date: _____

Vehicle year / make / model: _____

Do you currently maintain the auto insurance required for that vehicle? Yes No

Insurance expiration date: _____

Atlas Crest will verify the license and insurance securely before live work. Do not send the license image or insurance card in an ordinary email or text.

Phone and equipment

Phone type: iPhone Android

Model: _____

Do you have mobile data, a working camera, and location services? Yes No

Do you currently have: Extension pole / phone mount Measuring wheel Tape measure

If not, are you willing to obtain the required equipment before live work? Yes No

Service area and availability

Home ZIP code: _____



Counties, cities, or ZIP codes you can realistically cover:

Maximum one-way distance you would normally consider (miles): _____

Available days: Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

Available times: Morning Midday Afternoon Flexible

Other work or commitments that affect availability:

Experience and job fit

No prior inspection experience is required for entry-level exterior assignments.

Relevant inspection, insurance, construction, appraisal, real-estate, photography, delivery, or route experience:

Most recent or current work:

Are you comfortable speaking professionally with an occupant or property contact? Yes No

Are you able to walk around outdoor properties, including grass and uneven ground, and use a phone and measuring tool?

Yes No

Atlas Crest does not require medical information on this application. To request a reasonable modification to the application process or discuss how the essential work is performed, contact the Atlas Crest office.

Commercial work is not part of the role being offered. If Atlas Crest adds longer, scheduled commercial assignments later, would you want to be considered then? Yes No

Outside business, license, or industry role

Check anything that applies to you now or in the past twelve months:

Premium auditor

Property inspector / loss-control vendor

Appraiser or real-estate professional

Roofer, restoration provider, repair contractor, or other property-service provider

Other: _____

State(s) and type(s) of active professional license, if any:



Could a personal, family, financial, business, licensing, or professional relationship affect an assignment you are asked to inspect? Yes No

If yes, explain enough for Atlas Crest to screen assignments appropriately:

A disclosed outside business or license does not automatically disqualify an applicant. If engaged, however, the inspector may not promote any outside business, collect leads, solicit work, or use assignment contacts or information for a non-assignment purpose.

Applicant acknowledgment

Please initial each item:

- ☐ I understand this is assignment-based independent-contractor work, not hourly employment.
- ☐ I understand that assignments, routes, hours, and income are not guaranteed.
- ☐ I may accept or decline an offered assignment before it expires.
- ☐ I understand Atlas Crest may use my offer-response, completion, timeliness, quality, correction, and communication history for assignment matching and future offers.
- ☐ The fee is shown before I accept an assignment.
- ☐ I am responsible for my vehicle, fuel, mileage, phone, equipment, and taxes.
- ☐ I must complete the required agreements, IRS Form W-9, Found payment setup, background screening, training, and practice inspection before live work.
- ☐ Names, addresses, photographs, client information, and assignment details are confidential.
- ☐ I will use only the assignment-approved identity and materials, will disclose conflicts, and will not market or promote any outside business in connection with an Atlas Crest assignment.

I certify that this application is complete and accurate. I authorize Atlas Crest to contact me about it. Any background-report authorization will be provided separately.

Signature: _____ Date: _____



INDEPENDENT CONTRACTOR AGREEMENT — FIELD INSPECTION SERVICES

Atlas Crest LLC ("Company") and _____

("Contractor")

Effective date: _____

1. Relationship

Contractor is an independent contractor, not an employee, partner, or agent of Company. Contractor controls their own schedule, methods, and means of performing the Services. Company does not withhold income tax, Social Security, Medicare, or unemployment tax; Contractor is solely responsible for all taxes on amounts paid under this Agreement. Contractor receives no employee benefits of any kind and waives any claim to them, including health insurance, retirement, paid leave, unemployment compensation, and workers' compensation coverage from Company.

Contractor has no authority to enter into contracts, incur obligations, or make representations on Company's behalf, except for the narrow field-identification wording expressly authorized under Section 4 for a particular Assignment.

2. Services

Company will offer Contractor individual field inspection assignments ("Assignments") for insurance loss control and property inspection work. Each Assignment will state the property location, inspection type, due date, and the fee Company will pay for it.

Contractor is free to accept or decline any Assignment. Company does not guarantee any volume of Assignments or any level of income. Neither party owes the other any minimum commitment.

Company may record Contractor's response to each offer, including acceptance, decline, or expiration, and may maintain an internal reliability profile using response time, completion of accepted Assignments, timeliness, quality-review results, correction history, and communication. A declined offer is not a breach of this Agreement. Company may use the history for capacity planning, territory matching, quality management, client eligibility, and future Assignment decisions.

For each accepted Assignment, Contractor will:

- Contact the property contact when an Assignment requires an appointment or access coordination;
- Personally attend the property and perform the inspection;
- Capture all photographs, measurements, and interview answers required by the Assignment, using the Company-designated system or other method stated in the Assignment;
- Submit the completed capture to Company by the stated due date.

Company may update or replace its inspection platform, forms, security requirements, and operating instructions. Those changes do not alter the fee or materially expand the scope of an Assignment Contractor has already accepted without Contractor's written agreement. Platform instructions and operating guides do not amend this Agreement unless both parties sign a written amendment.

Contractor will not perform any Assignment they are not qualified to perform. Time is of the essence on every Assignment. Contractor will tell Company within 24 hours of learning of anything likely to cause a delay — an Assignment beyond their ability, an unresponsive or uncooperative property contact, a locked or inaccessible property, illness, or a vehicle problem.



3. Personal performance — no delegation

Contractor will personally perform every Assignment they accept. Contractor will not subcontract, delegate, or assign any Assignment, or bring any other person to the property to perform any part of the inspection, without Company's prior written consent.

By submitting a completed Assignment, Contractor represents that Contractor personally attended the property and personally captured the submitted photographs, measurements, and answers on the date recorded.

4. All client communication runs through Company

Company's clients include inspection service providers, insurance carriers, and insurance agents. Contractor will not contact any client of Company — including any inspection service provider, carrier, or agent — regarding any Assignment, Contractor's status, payment, or any other matter, unless Company directs it in writing for a specific purpose.

Contractor will direct all questions, problems, and scheduling issues to Company.

Contractor's contractual and payment relationship is solely with Company. For each Assignment, Contractor will use only the identification wording, badge, verification procedure, door hanger or sticker, and other field-identification material Company designates based on the applicable client's written requirements. Contractor will not substitute Contractor's own or any outside business's badge, script, card, or material.

An Assignment may authorize Contractor to identify using a client's name or to state that the visit is on behalf of a carrier. That narrow identification does not make Contractor an employee, agent, producer, adjuster, auditor, or general representative of Company, the client, any carrier, or any agent. Contractor will not claim authority beyond the exact Assignment purpose and approved wording.

Contractor may not perform an Assignment requiring client clearance, a badge, or other credentials until Company confirms that the requirement is satisfied. Every badge, credential, and account is personal and nontransferable. Contractor will keep it secure, will not duplicate or lend it, will report loss or theft immediately, and will return or stop using it when Company or the issuing client requests or when this Agreement ends.

5. Non-circumvention

During this Agreement and for twelve (12) months after it ends, Contractor will not, directly or indirectly, solicit or accept inspection work from any client of Company that Contractor became aware of through this Agreement, other than through Company.

During the same period, Contractor will not use Company's Confidential Information — including Company's client relationships, fee schedules, training, forms, processes, and software — to establish, operate, or work for a business that competes with Company for that client's inspection work, and will not solicit or recruit any other contractor or employee of Company.

This does not restrict Contractor from performing inspection work for any company Contractor already had a relationship with before this Agreement, or from working for any company Contractor identifies independently of Company. Nothing here prevents Contractor from earning a living in the inspection industry generally.

6. Confidentiality and insured privacy

Contractor will treat as confidential, and will not disclose or use for any purpose other than performing Assignments:

- The identity of Company's clients and the terms on which Company works with them;
- Insured and property-owner names, addresses, contact information, policy information, and any other personal or business information encountered during an Assignment;
- Photographs, measurements, diagrams, and inspection findings;
- Company's software, forms, checklists, pricing, and methods.



Contractor will not post, publish, share, or discuss any property, insured, photograph, or inspection finding on social media or with any third party.

Obligations regarding insured and property-owner information are perpetual. Obligations regarding Company's client relationships, fee schedules, software, forms, and methods continue for as long as that information is not public, and in any event for at least three (3) years after this Agreement ends.

Contractor will send and store assignment material only through the channels Company designates, and will keep the device used for Assignments locked with a passcode or biometric.

After a completed Assignment is submitted and Company confirms receipt, Contractor will delete inspection photographs and insured information from Contractor's personal devices and accounts, unless Company gives a written preservation instruction for quality review, a client request, or a legal matter. On termination, or whenever Company asks, Contractor will return or delete all of it and confirm in writing that it is done, subject to any written preservation instruction.

Contractor will notify Company within 24 hours of any suspected loss, theft, or unauthorized disclosure of Confidential Information, including a lost or stolen phone holding assignment data.

7. Work product

All photographs, measurements, diagrams, notes, recordings, answers, and reports created by Contractor in performing an Assignment are the exclusive property of Company. Contractor assigns to Company all rights, including copyright, in that work product. Contractor will sign any document reasonably needed to confirm that assignment.

Contractor retains no license to reuse, resell, or publish the work product.

Company's training guides, checklists, forms, platforms, software, and processes remain Company's property and are licensed to Contractor only for performing Assignments while this Agreement is in effect. Contractor gains no rights in any client's training materials, systems, or credentials, and will not copy, reproduce, forward, or show Company's or any client's materials to any other person. On termination Contractor will stop using and will delete all such materials.

8. Quality review and correction

Company reviews and performs quality assurance on all submitted work before it goes to any client. Company may return an Assignment to Contractor for correction, additional photographs, or a return visit if the submission is incomplete, unclear, or does not meet client requirements.

Contractor will make corrections within 24 hours of notice — Company's clients commonly impose a 24-hour correction window, and a late correction can cost Company the assignment. A return visit needed because Contractor missed required items is part of the original Assignment and does not carry an additional fee. A return visit needed because the client changed or expanded the scope will be paid as a new Assignment.

9. Compensation

Company will pay the fee stated in each Assignment. Fees are per inspection, not hourly.

Payment is made weekly by ACH through Found, for Assignments that were submitted complete and approved through Company's quality review during the prior week. An Assignment that is pending correction is paid after the correction is accepted.

Contractor bears all of Contractor's own costs, including vehicle and mileage, fuel, phone and data, camera, measuring equipment, and any licensing or certification Contractor chooses to maintain. Company does not reimburse expenses unless agreed in writing in advance for a specific Assignment.

Before Company issues any payment, Contractor must provide a completed IRS Form W-9 and must complete the secure Found payment profile Company sends. Company will issue Form 1099-NEC when required by the reporting threshold and other rules applicable to the calendar year of payment.



10. Contractor's requirements

Contractor represents and will maintain throughout this Agreement:

- A valid driver's license and reliable transportation;
- Automobile liability insurance meeting at least the minimum requirements of each state where Contractor operates;
- A smartphone capable of using Company's then-current mobile inspection tools, with a working camera;
- A measuring wheel or comparable measuring device, where the Assignment requires measurements;
- Legal authorization to work in the United States;
- General liability insurance only if Company later offers Contractor a type of Assignment that requires it, such as commercial work. No such Assignment is offered under this Agreement today, and Company will say so in writing before assigning any work that requires this coverage.

Contractor will tell Company promptly if any of these lapses.

11. Background check

Company's clients require that every person performing inspections be background checked. Contractor will receive any legally required disclosure and authorization as a separate document or through the approved screening provider. This Agreement does not replace that separate process. Contractor will provide sensitive information the check requires directly to the screening provider or client through its secure process.

Contractor may not perform any live Assignment before clearing the background check. Company may end this Agreement immediately if Contractor does not clear, or does not remain clear.

Contractor will tell Company promptly of any criminal charge, driver's license suspension, lapse in auto insurance, or other event that could disqualify Contractor from performing work for any Company client.

12. Conduct at the property

Contractor will be professional and courteous with insureds, property contacts, and the public. Contractor will:

- Enter only those areas the property contact permits;
- Take photographs only as the Assignment requires, and stop if the contact refuses — noting the refusal rather than proceeding;
- Not enter a property where Contractor reasonably believes there is a safety hazard, and report the condition to Company instead;
- Not give the insured coverage advice, premium opinions, or any statement about what a carrier will or will not do;
- Not accept payment, gifts, or gratuities from any insured, contact, or agent.

Outside work and no solicitation

Contractor may lawfully work elsewhere and maintain other businesses, clients, and licenses. But during an Assignment, in any Assignment communication, or through any Assignment contact, relationship, or information, Contractor will not:

- Advertise, solicit, recommend, refer, quote, sell, or offer any outside product or service, including insurance, adjusting or public adjusting, premium audits, inspections, roofing, restoration, repairs, contracting, real estate, or financing;
- Collect a lead, add any insured, occupant, owner, agent, or other Assignment contact to a marketing list, or contact that person later for a non-Assignment purpose;
- Display or distribute an outside-business card, flyer, QR code, referral link, badge, lanyard, uniform, logo, or other promotion, or use a prominently outside-business-branded vehicle without Company's prior written approval;



- State or imply that an outside business is affiliated with, endorsed by, referred by, or acting for Company, a client, a carrier, or an agent; or
- Accept or arrange side work, a commission, a referral fee, or other value arising from an Assignment contact or relationship.

Conflicts of interest

Before accepting an Assignment, Contractor will disclose any personal, family, financial, professional, licensing, agency, adjuster, contractor, vendor, or prior-client relationship involving the property, insured, occupant, business, agent, carrier, or service provider. Contractor will not accept a conflicted Assignment unless Company confirms in writing that the disclosed circumstances do not require reassignment.

13. Indemnification

Contractor will indemnify and hold Company harmless from claims, losses, and expenses arising from Contractor's breach of this Agreement, Contractor's negligent or willful acts, Contractor's operation of a vehicle, Contractor's misrepresentation of facts in a submitted Assignment, any claim that Contractor is an employee of Company, or Contractor's failure to pay taxes or to maintain the licenses and insurance required by this Agreement.

Company will indemnify and hold Contractor harmless from claims arising from Company's own negligent or willful acts.

Neither party is liable to the other for indirect, incidental, or consequential damages. Company's total liability under this Agreement is limited to the fees payable for Assignments Contractor has completed.

14. Term and termination

This Agreement begins on the effective date and continues until ended. Either party may end it at any time, for any reason, with written notice — including by email.

Contractor will complete or promptly hand back any accepted Assignment that is still open. Company will pay for completed work through the termination date. Sections 3, 5, 6, 7, 9 (as to amounts owed), 13, 15, and 16 survive termination.

15. Workers' compensation and injuries

Contractor is not covered by Company's workers' compensation insurance and is not promised workers' compensation benefits from Company. Contractor is responsible for determining and meeting the workers' compensation requirements that apply to Contractor's business form, workforce, state, and operations. Contractor will maintain coverage when legally required and, when Company reasonably requests it, provide proof of coverage, a valid entity-owner exemption, or other documentation appropriate to Contractor's actual legal status. Contractor will indemnify Company against a claim arising from Contractor's failure to carry coverage the law requires.

Contractor performs every Assignment at Contractor's own risk, including travel to and from the property. Contractor will report any injury, accident, or property damage occurring during an Assignment to Company within 24 hours.

If Contractor engages any helper, employee, or subcontractor — which Section 3 does not permit without Company's written consent — Contractor is solely responsible for that person's coverage, taxes, supervision, and conduct.

16. Enforcement

Contractor agrees that a breach of Section 3, 5, 6, or 7 would cause Company harm that money alone cannot repair, and that Company may seek an injunction or other equitable relief to stop or prevent the breach, in addition to any damages, without posting a bond.

In any dispute arising out of this Agreement, the prevailing party is entitled to recover its reasonable attorney's fees and costs, including on appeal.



17. General

This Agreement is governed by the laws of the State of Florida, except that any mandatory law of the state or locality where Contractor performs Services will apply when it cannot lawfully be waived. Any dispute will be brought in a state or federal court with lawful jurisdiction and venue, subject to any nonwaivable venue right. It is the entire agreement between the parties on this subject and replaces all prior discussions and any earlier version of this agreement. It may be amended only in writing signed by both parties. If any provision is unenforceable, it is reformed to the minimum extent needed and the rest remains in effect. Contractor may not assign this Agreement. Company may assign it to a successor or affiliate.

Notices may be given by email to the addresses on the signature page and are effective on receipt. This Agreement may be signed in counterparts and by electronic signature, each of which counts as an original.

ATLAS CREST LLC

Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

Name: Hunter Tubb · Title: President

CONTRACTOR

Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

Printed name: _____

Address: _____

Phone: _____ **Email:** _____



CONFIDENTIALITY AND DATA-PROTECTION ACKNOWLEDGMENT

This acknowledgment is between Atlas Crest LLC ("Company") and _____

("Inspector"). It supplements the Independent Contractor Agreement for field inspection services. If this acknowledgment conflicts with that agreement, the agreement controls.

1. Confidential information

Inspector may receive or observe confidential information, including:

- Insured, occupant, property-owner, and business names, addresses, telephone numbers, email addresses, access instructions, policy-related information, and other personal or business data;
- Property photographs, measurements, diagrams, interview answers, observations, notes, inspection results, and assignment status;
- Company and client identities, relationships, pricing, service areas, forms, standards, checklists, training, software, credentials, processes, and communications.

Confidential information does not include information Inspector can document was already lawfully known without a confidentiality duty, became public without Inspector's breach, or was lawfully received from an independent source without a confidentiality duty.

2. Limited use and nondisclosure

Inspector will use confidential information only to perform an accepted Company assignment. Inspector will not disclose it to any other person, post it online, use it for marketing, use it to solicit work, or use it for any personal or commercial purpose outside the assignment.

Inspector will not contact a Company client, carrier, agent, or inspection service provider unless Company gives written direction for a specific purpose. This restriction does not prevent normal contact with an insured or property contact required to schedule or perform an assignment.

Inspector will not use any assignment name, address, telephone number, email address, professional relationship, or other contact information to collect a lead, build a marketing list, make a referral, promote an outside business, or contact the person later for a non-assignment purpose.

3. Device and account protection

Inspector will:

- Keep every work device protected by a passcode or biometric lock;
- Keep all Company-system sign-in methods, links, and credentials private and never allow another person to use them;
- Use only Company-approved apps, folders, and communication channels for assignment material;
- Avoid saving assignment material to personal cloud photo libraries or shared accounts;
- Take reasonable steps to prevent family members, passengers, or other people from viewing data;
- Notify Company immediately, and no later than 24 hours, of a lost device, compromised account, misdirected message, or suspected unauthorized access or disclosure.

4. Photographs, metadata, and records

Inspector will submit original, current assignment material and will not erase, alter, falsify, or strip location, date, time, or other source metadata. Inspector will not reuse a photograph or record from another property, assignment, date, or person.



All assignment work product belongs to Company as stated in the Independent Contractor Agreement. Inspector will provide original files or notes when reasonably requested for quality review, client review, or a legal inquiry.

5. Return and deletion

After Company confirms receipt, or whenever Company requests, Inspector will delete assignment photographs and confidential information from personal devices, messages, downloads, backups, and personal accounts, subject to any written preservation instruction from Company.

At the end of the relationship, Inspector will return Company property, stop using Company and client systems, delete confidential material, and confirm completion in writing if requested.

6. Duration and required disclosures

The duty to protect insured, occupant, and property information continues indefinitely. Duties covering nonpublic Company and client business information continue while that information remains nonpublic and for at least three years after the relationship ends.

If law, subpoena, or court order requires disclosure, Inspector will notify Company promptly when legally permitted and disclose only what is required.

7. Acknowledgment

Inspector understands that a breach may harm insureds, clients, and Company and may result in immediate removal from assignments, termination, damages, or court relief under the Independent Contractor Agreement.

ATLAS CREST LLC

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Name: Hunter Tubb, President

INSPECTOR

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Printed name: _____



BACKGROUND-CHECK DISCLOSURE AND AUTHORIZATION

Disclosure

Atlas Crest LLC may obtain one or more background reports about you for the purpose of deciding whether to engage, assign, retain, or continue using you for field-inspection services. A report may contain information about criminal records, identity verification, driving history, or other information relevant to client eligibility and the work, depending on the screening requested.

A report may be obtained from a third-party screening provider or through a client-required screening process. Atlas Crest may receive only an eligibility result rather than the full report.

This document concerns background reports only. It is separate from the application, job description, Independent Contractor Agreement, confidentiality acknowledgment, and any liability release.

Authorization

I authorize Atlas Crest LLC, its authorized screening provider, and a client-required screening provider to obtain background reports about me for the purposes described above. I authorize the procurement of an initial report and, if I perform assignments for Atlas Crest, additional reports during the relationship when required for continued client eligibility or permitted by law.

I understand that I may be asked to provide identifying information directly to the screening provider through its secure process. I will not send a Social Security number, bank information, or identification document through ordinary email or text.

I understand that signing this authorization does not guarantee engagement or assignments. I may request information about the screening provider and applicable rights. If Atlas Crest receives a consumer report and may take adverse action based on it, Atlas Crest will follow any legally required pre-adverse and adverse-action process.

Applicant information

Full legal name: _____

Other names used, if requested by the screening provider:

Current address: _____

City / State / ZIP: _____

Email: _____ Phone: _____

Date of birth: _____

DO NOT ADD ANYTHING ELSE HERE

Do not write a Social Security number or driver's-license number on this form. The screening provider will collect that directly through its own secure process.

Signature: _____ Date: _____



INSPECTOR PAYMENT SETUP — ACH THROUGH FOUND

Atlas Crest pays approved inspection work weekly by ACH through Found. Found is the only payment method used for inspector payments. Complete this page after you decide to move forward. Atlas Crest must also receive a completed IRS Form W-9 before issuing payment.

SECURITY RULE — READ THIS FIRST

Do not write your bank routing or account number on this form, and do not send banking information by ordinary email or text. You will enter your banking information yourself, directly into the secure Found request that Atlas Crest sends you. Atlas Crest never asks for those numbers any other way.

Your information

Name as shown on your W-9: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

Found sends its secure onboarding request to this email address, so make sure it is one you check.

Mailing address for tax documents: _____

City / State / ZIP: _____

How setup works

1. Atlas Crest sends you a secure Found payment-onboarding request by email.
2. You enter your routing and account information directly in the secure Found process. Atlas Crest does not see or store those numbers.
3. Atlas Crest confirms your payment profile is complete before your first approved payment.
4. Approved inspection work is paid weekly by ACH under the Independent Contractor Agreement.

Authorization

I confirm that the information above is correct. I authorize Atlas Crest LLC to send payments by ACH to the account I set up through Found and, when legally permitted, to correct a payment made in error. I will notify Atlas Crest in writing, and update my Found payment profile, before changing payment instructions.

I understand payment is by ACH through Found and that I will enter my banking information only in the secure Found request.

Signature: _____ Date: _____



INSPECTOR ONBOARDING — WHAT TO REVIEW AND RETURN

Thank you for confirming that you want to move forward. This packet contains the full description and paperwork for the field-inspector opportunity. Read everything before signing.

SECURE INFORMATION STAYS SEPARATE

Do not place a Social Security number, bank information, driver's-license image, insurance document, or background-screening information in an ordinary email body or text message. Atlas Crest will provide the applicable secure Found or screening process, a private folder, or an in-person option.

Read and keep

- Full Job Description
- Inspector Application
- Field Inspector Guide
- Copy of the signed Independent Contractor Agreement
- Copy of the signed Confidentiality and Data-Protection Acknowledgment

Complete and return

- Completed Inspector Application
- Signed Independent Contractor Agreement
- Signed Confidentiality and Data-Protection Acknowledgment
- Signed Background-Check Disclosure and Authorization
- Completed IRS Form W-9 (the fillable form at the back of this packet), returned through the secure method Atlas Crest provides
- Completed Payment Setup page, followed by the secure Found payment-onboarding request Atlas Crest emails you
- Clear image of the front of your current driver's license
- Current auto-insurance card or declarations page
- Professional badge photograph, if requested through the secure onboarding process; the photo must not show another company's logo, business name, uniform, or promotional material
- Any workers' compensation document Atlas Crest requests after reviewing your business type



What happens next

1. Atlas Crest checks the returned paperwork for completeness.
2. The required background screening is submitted through the approved secure process.
3. You complete the Atlas Crest training and written knowledge check.
4. You complete a required practice inspection using your own home, or another property where you have the owner's or occupant's permission.
5. The practice inspection must include the full required photo set and measurements. Atlas Crest reviews framing, lighting, sharpness, coverage, address verification, roof views from the ground, and notes, then returns coaching or requests another practice attempt when needed.
6. Atlas Crest verifies your access to the current inspection system, tests submission from your phone, and confirms any client-required clearance, badge, identity wording, and field materials.
7. Only after every gate clears may Atlas Crest offer a small first route near your service area. Every assignment remains optional until you accept it, and volume and income are not guaranteed.

PRACTICE PROPERTY PERMISSION

Never use a stranger's property or represent the practice visit as a live insurance inspection. If the property is not your home, obtain permission before taking any photographs or measurements.

Questions: Atlas Crest office · office@atlascrestllc.com · (863) 444-6700



ATLAS CREST FIELD INSPECTOR GUIDE — PHOTO STANDARDS

This is Atlas Crest's own training material. It was written for Atlas Crest inspectors. Client training material is not included. Any client identity, badge, credential, verification contact, or field material supplied for a cleared assignment is confidential, personal to the authorized inspector, limited to that work, and may not be copied or shared.

System-neutral rule. Atlas Crest may update or replace the field platform. References below to the "field system" mean the Company-designated platform, portal, or other workflow identified for the assignment. The assignment instructions and the current screen labels control the operating steps; this guide controls the standing safety, integrity, privacy, and photo-quality standards.

The one rule over all others

Never fake anything. Photos may be checked against the property, time, location, and prior submissions. A reused or wrong-property photo isn't a redo — it's the end of the contract. If you can't get a photo (locked gate, dog, weather), use the field system's office-contact function or the current Company-designated contact method and say so. An honest "couldn't access" is always fine. A faked photo never is.

Before you leave the house

1. Open the field system and review each offer before it expires. An offer you do not accept may go to someone else. Silence is not acceptance.
2. Look at the case: address, due date, and the shot list the field system shows for that job. **Read the notes on the case before anything else** — special instructions define the required scope. They never override safety, privacy, or the signed agreement. If instructions conflict, ask Atlas Crest before proceeding.
3. Phone charged, location/GPS ON, camera lens wiped clean.
4. Confirm you have the current assignment-approved badge, identity wording, verification contact, and door material. Never use a badge or door material from another client, and never substitute an Atlas Crest card unless the assignment instructions expressly require it.
5. Plan your run — jobs may come clustered; any displayed route order is a suggestion unless an appointment window or access instruction requires a specific time.

Arriving at the property

1. Confirm you're at the right address — the number on the house must match the case.
2. Wear the assignment-approved badge where it is clearly visible. Carry your valid driver's license in case identity verification is requested. Never share or lend a badge.
3. If someone is home or comes out, be friendly and use the exact identity wording supplied for that assignment. Do not improvise a company name. A typical approved format is: "Hi, my name is [name]. I'm with [name stated in the assignment instructions], and I'm here on behalf of the insurance carrier to complete a routine property inspection." Use that format only when it matches the current written instructions.
4. Never discuss their coverage, premium, claims, or what the report might say. If they have questions: "The office can help with that" — and log it with Contact Office.
5. If they question your identity or authority, show the approved badge and direct them to the verification contact shown on the badge or supplied in the assignment instructions.
6. If they refuse, get upset, or it feels unsafe: leave politely, log it through the designated field or office-contact method, done. You are never expected to argue your way onto a property.
7. Stay out of the house unless the assignment specifically includes interior.



8. Never climb a fence, force a gate, or move someone's property to get a shot. If you can't reach it, photograph what's blocking you and note it.
9. Don't ask to use a bathroom, and don't accept food, drinks, cash, gifts, referral fees, or side work.
10. No marketing or side business. Do not discuss, recommend, quote, sell, or refer any outside product or service. Do not hand out a personal or outside-business card, collect a lead, display an outside-business logo or uniform, or contact the person later for a non-assignment purpose.
11. If a child under 18 answers and no adult is there, leave. Note it and move on.
12. Leave only the door hanger, sticker, or card the assignment instructions approve. Use the correct client material for that assignment even when nobody is home; never leave outside-business material.

The standard exterior shot list

Take them in this order every time — order is how you never miss one:

1. Street scene — stand back, house number or mailbox visible in frame.
2. Front elevation — the whole front of the home, corner to corner, roofline to ground.
3. Right side elevation — the whole side.
4. Rear elevation — the whole back.
5. Left side elevation — the whole side. (You've now walked a full lap.)
6. Roof, all visible slopes — from each corner of the lot, angled to show the roof surface. Zoom in on anything that looks worn, patched, tarped, or damaged: one close-up plus one step-back shot so we can tell where on the roof it is.
7. Electrical service — meter and mast/weatherhead; the panel too if it's outside (door open, breakers readable).
8. A/C or heat pump — the outdoor unit, full unit in frame; data plate close-up if legible.
9. Every hazard you can see — photograph all that apply: pool or hot tub, and its fence and gate (show whether the gate latches); trampoline, playset, treehouse; dog, "beware of dog" sign, chain or run; trees overhanging the roof, dead trees; stairs, decks, porches, and railings or missing railings; debris piles, inoperable vehicles, stored fuel, or anything that looks like a business being run from the property.
10. Outbuildings — every shed, detached garage, barn, carport: one full shot each.
11. Anything damaged or unusual — close-up plus context shot. When in doubt, shoot it. Extra photos never hurt you; missing photos always do.

If the assignment includes interior: water heater (full unit plus data plate), electrical panel (door open, labels readable), under-sink plumbing, each room wide from the doorway, and any wood stove or fireplace. The assignment-specific shot list in the current field system is always the final word.

How to take a photo that is approved in review

- Capture through the designated field workflow, at the property. Do not substitute old or unrelated gallery photos; any permitted attachment must still be original, current assignment evidence.
- Hold still. Tap the screen to focus, pause a beat, then shoot. Blurry photos are auto-rejected and you'll be asked to reshoot — a return trip you don't get paid extra for.
- Landscape (sideways) for buildings, portrait only for tall narrow things (panels, water heaters).
- Sun behind you whenever possible. Shooting into the sun makes a black silhouette — auto-rejected. Overcast is fine. Too dark to see detail is not.
- Whole subject in frame. An elevation means corner-to-corner, roof-to-ground. If you can't back up far enough, take two overlapping shots.
- Close-ups get a context shot. One photo showing what, one showing where.
- Don't include people's faces if you can avoid it; never photograph through windows.



When you can't get something

The rule that separates a professional from a problem: a labeled gap is fine, a quietly filled one is not.

- Couldn't reach the back yard? Photograph the locked gate or the dog, and say so.
- Had to estimate a measurement? Say it's estimated, and why.
- Never guess a number to make something look complete. Never reuse a photo from another angle to fill an empty slot. One invented detail costs more than every job you have done.
- If you measure, measure it yourself. County records and online diagrams go stale — they are a starting point, never proof.
- "Nobody was home" is not a reason to close out an exterior job. If the property is reachable and nobody refused, do the inspection. On jobs that do require contact, log every attempt — who you tried, the date, the time, and how.
- Anything you are unsure about, ask before you guess. A question costs a minute; a wrong closeout costs the case.

Privacy — not negotiable

You will be photographing people's homes and, on some jobs, handling their documents.

- Never type a Social Security number, date of birth, or bank information into any field, note, or message.
- Photos and case details are the client's property. They never go on social media, never get texted to a friend, never get shown as an example. Not once.
- Keep your phone locked with a passcode. If you lose it, contact the Atlas Crest office the same day.

Before you drive away

1. Open the case in the field system and check every required slot on the shot list is filled.
2. Look at each photo full-screen for two seconds — blurry or dark ones, reshoot now while you're standing there. This is the single biggest time-saver in this job.
3. Save or submit from the property using the current field workflow. Confirm the system shows the evidence as saved or queued before leaving; follow the current offline procedure if service is unavailable.
4. Anything odd about the visit — use the designated office-contact method before you pull away, while you remember.

Getting paid

- Pay is per completed, accepted inspection at the rate stated on the offer.
- A job isn't complete until it is approved through quality review. Returned photos remain unpaid until corrected.
- Payment is weekly by ACH through Found, once your W-9 and Found payment profile are complete.
- Getting work returned is normal, especially in your first month. Everyone gets returns. Fix them the same day and they cost you nothing. Letting one sit for a week is the actual problem, and it is the thing that ends contracts.
- Atlas Crest tracks offer responses, response time, accepted-work completion, timeliness, submission quality, correction history, and communication in an internal reliability profile. That history supports route matching, additional responsibility, and future offer decisions. The standard is simple: respond promptly, do clean work, communicate, and never fake anything.



IRS FORM W-9 — REQUEST FOR TAXPAYER IDENTIFICATION NUMBER

The pages that follow are the official IRS Form W-9 (Rev. March 2024), reproduced exactly as the IRS publishes it. The form is fillable — you can type into it and sign it electronically, or print it and complete it by hand.

Atlas Crest must have a completed W-9 on file before issuing any payment. The W-9 is what allows Atlas Crest to report your contractor earnings correctly on Form 1099-NEC.

How to complete it for Atlas Crest

1. **Line 1 — Name.** Enter your own legal name, exactly as it appears on your tax return. This is required even if you operate under a business name.
2. **Line 2 — Business name.** Leave blank unless your business or disregarded-entity name differs from the name you entered above.
3. **Line 3a — Federal tax classification.** Most individual inspectors check "Individual/sole proprietor." If you inspect through an LLC or corporation, check the box that matches how that entity is taxed.
4. **Line 3b.** Leave blank unless you are a partnership, trust, or estate with foreign partners, owners, or beneficiaries.
5. **Line 4 — Exemptions.** Almost always blank for an individual contractor.
6. **Lines 5 and 6 — Address.** Use the address where you want tax documents mailed. It should match the mailing address on your Payment Setup page.
7. **Part I — TIN.** Enter your Social Security number, or your EIN if you are paid through a business entity. Enter one, not both.
8. **Part II — Certification.** Sign and date. An unsigned W-9 cannot be accepted.

RETURN THE W-9 SECURELY

Your W-9 contains your Social Security number or EIN. Do not email or text it as an ordinary attachment. Return it only through the secure method Atlas Crest gives you — a private upload folder or an in-person handoff. If you have not received a secure return method yet, ask before you send anything.

If you need help

Atlas Crest cannot give tax advice. IRS instructions for the form begin on page 3 of the W-9 itself, and the current version and guidance are always at www.irs.gov/FormW9. For questions about your own tax situation, speak with a tax professional.

**Request for Taxpayer
Identification Number and Certification**

Go to www.irs.gov/FormW9 for instructions and the latest information.

**Give form to the
requester. Do not
send to the IRS.**

Before you begin. For guidance related to the purpose of Form W-9, see *Purpose of Form*, below.

Print or type. See Specific Instructions on page 3.	1 Name of entity/individual. An entry is required. (For a sole proprietor or disregarded entity, enter the owner's name on line 1, and enter the business/disregarded entity's name on line 2.)	
	2 Business name/disregarded entity name, if different from above.	
	3a Check the appropriate box for federal tax classification of the entity/individual whose name is entered on line 1. Check only one of the following seven boxes. ☐ Individual/sole proprietor ☐ C corporation ☐ S corporation ☐ Partnership ☐ Trust/estate ☐ LLC. Enter the tax classification (C = C corporation, S = S corporation, P = Partnership) Note: Check the "LLC" box above and, in the entry space, enter the appropriate code (C, S, or P) for the tax classification of the LLC, unless it is a disregarded entity. A disregarded entity should instead check the appropriate box for the tax classification of its owner. ☐ Other (see instructions) _____	4 Exemptions (codes apply only to certain entities, not individuals; see instructions on page 3): Exempt payee code (if any) _____ Exemption from Foreign Account Tax Compliance Act (FATCA) reporting code (if any) _____ (Applies to accounts maintained outside the United States.)
	3b If on line 3a you checked "Partnership" or "Trust/estate," or checked "LLC" and entered "P" as its tax classification, and you are providing this form to a partnership, trust, or estate in which you have an ownership interest, check this box if you have any foreign partners, owners, or beneficiaries. See instructions ☐	
	5 Address (number, street, and apt. or suite no.). See instructions.	Requester's name and address (optional)
	6 City, state, and ZIP code	
	7 List account number(s) here (optional)	

Part I Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)

Enter your TIN in the appropriate box. The TIN provided must match the name given on line 1 to avoid backup withholding. For individuals, this is generally your social security number (SSN). However, for a resident alien, sole proprietor, or disregarded entity, see the instructions for Part I, later. For other entities, it is your employer identification number (EIN). If you do not have a number, see *How to get a TIN*, later.

Note: If the account is in more than one name, see the instructions for line 1. See also *What Name and Number To Give the Requester* for guidelines on whose number to enter.

Social security number											
				-				-			
or											
Employer identification number											
					-						

Part II Certification

Under penalties of perjury, I certify that:

- The number shown on this form is my correct taxpayer identification number (or I am waiting for a number to be issued to me); and
- I am not subject to backup withholding because (a) I am exempt from backup withholding, or (b) I have not been notified by the Internal Revenue Service (IRS) that I am subject to backup withholding as a result of a failure to report all interest or dividends, or (c) the IRS has notified me that I am no longer subject to backup withholding; and
- I am a U.S. citizen or other U.S. person (defined below); and
- The FATCA code(s) entered on this form (if any) indicating that I am exempt from FATCA reporting is correct.

Certification instructions. You must cross out item 2 above if you have been notified by the IRS that you are currently subject to backup withholding because you have failed to report all interest and dividends on your tax return. For real estate transactions, item 2 does not apply. For mortgage interest paid, acquisition or abandonment of secured property, cancellation of debt, contributions to an individual retirement arrangement (IRA), and, generally, payments other than interest and dividends, you are not required to sign the certification, but you must provide your correct TIN. See the instructions for Part II, later.

Sign Here	Signature of U.S. person	Date
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General Instructions

Section references are to the Internal Revenue Code unless otherwise noted.

Future developments. For the latest information about developments related to Form W-9 and its instructions, such as legislation enacted after they were published, go to www.irs.gov/FormW9.

What's New

Line 3a has been modified to clarify how a disregarded entity completes this line. An LLC that is a disregarded entity should check the appropriate box for the tax classification of its owner. Otherwise, it should check the "LLC" box and enter its appropriate tax classification.

New line 3b has been added to this form. A flow-through entity is required to complete this line to indicate that it has direct or indirect foreign partners, owners, or beneficiaries when it provides the Form W-9 to another flow-through entity in which it has an ownership interest. This change is intended to provide a flow-through entity with information regarding the status of its indirect foreign partners, owners, or beneficiaries, so that it can satisfy any applicable reporting requirements. For example, a partnership that has any indirect foreign partners may be required to complete Schedules K-2 and K-3. See the Partnership Instructions for Schedules K-2 and K-3 (Form 1065).

Purpose of Form

An individual or entity (Form W-9 requester) who is required to file an information return with the IRS is giving you this form because they

must obtain your correct taxpayer identification number (TIN), which may be your social security number (SSN), individual taxpayer identification number (ITIN), adoption taxpayer identification number (ATIN), or employer identification number (EIN), to report on an information return the amount paid to you, or other amount reportable on an information return. Examples of information returns include, but are not limited to, the following.

- Form 1099-INT (interest earned or paid).
- Form 1099-DIV (dividends, including those from stocks or mutual funds).
- Form 1099-MISC (various types of income, prizes, awards, or gross proceeds).
- Form 1099-NEC (nonemployee compensation).
- Form 1099-B (stock or mutual fund sales and certain other transactions by brokers).
- Form 1099-S (proceeds from real estate transactions).
- Form 1099-K (merchant card and third-party network transactions).
- Form 1098 (home mortgage interest), 1098-E (student loan interest), and 1098-T (tuition).
- Form 1099-C (canceled debt).
- Form 1099-A (acquisition or abandonment of secured property).

Use Form W-9 only if you are a U.S. person (including a resident alien), to provide your correct TIN.

Caution: If you don't return Form W-9 to the requester with a TIN, you might be subject to backup withholding. See *What is backup withholding*, later.

By signing the filled-out form, you:

1. Certify that the TIN you are giving is correct (or you are waiting for a number to be issued);
2. Certify that you are not subject to backup withholding; or
3. Claim exemption from backup withholding if you are a U.S. exempt payee; and
4. Certify to your non-foreign status for purposes of withholding under chapter 3 or 4 of the Code (if applicable); and
5. Certify that FATCA code(s) entered on this form (if any) indicating that you are exempt from the FATCA reporting is correct. See *What Is FATCA Reporting*, later, for further information.

Note: If you are a U.S. person and a requester gives you a form other than Form W-9 to request your TIN, you must use the requester's form if it is substantially similar to this Form W-9.

Definition of a U.S. person. For federal tax purposes, you are considered a U.S. person if you are:

- An individual who is a U.S. citizen or U.S. resident alien;
- A partnership, corporation, company, or association created or organized in the United States or under the laws of the United States;
- An estate (other than a foreign estate); or
- A domestic trust (as defined in Regulations section 301.7701-7).

Establishing U.S. status for purposes of chapter 3 and chapter 4 withholding. Payments made to foreign persons, including certain distributions, allocations of income, or transfers of sales proceeds, may be subject to withholding under chapter 3 or chapter 4 of the Code (sections 1441–1474). Under those rules, if a Form W-9 or other certification of non-foreign status has not been received, a withholding agent, transferee, or partnership (payor) generally applies presumption rules that may require the payor to withhold applicable tax from the recipient, owner, transferor, or partner (payee). See Pub. 515, *Withholding of Tax on Nonresident Aliens and Foreign Entities*.

The following persons must provide Form W-9 to the payor for purposes of establishing its non-foreign status.

- In the case of a disregarded entity with a U.S. owner, the U.S. owner of the disregarded entity and not the disregarded entity.
- In the case of a grantor trust with a U.S. grantor or other U.S. owner, generally, the U.S. grantor or other U.S. owner of the grantor trust and not the grantor trust.
- In the case of a U.S. trust (other than a grantor trust), the U.S. trust and not the beneficiaries of the trust.

See Pub. 515 for more information on providing a Form W-9 or a certification of non-foreign status to avoid withholding.

Foreign person. If you are a foreign person or the U.S. branch of a foreign bank that has elected to be treated as a U.S. person (under Regulations section 1.1441-1(b)(2)(iv) or other applicable section for chapter 3 or 4 purposes), do not use Form W-9. Instead, use the appropriate Form W-8 or Form 8233 (see Pub. 515). If you are a qualified foreign pension fund under Regulations section 1.897(l)-1(d), or a partnership that is wholly owned by qualified foreign pension funds, that is treated as a non-foreign person for purposes of section 1445 withholding, do not use Form W-9. Instead, use Form W-8EXP (or other certification of non-foreign status).

Nonresident alien who becomes a resident alien. Generally, only a nonresident alien individual may use the terms of a tax treaty to reduce or eliminate U.S. tax on certain types of income. However, most tax treaties contain a provision known as a saving clause. Exceptions specified in the saving clause may permit an exemption from tax to continue for certain types of income even after the payee has otherwise become a U.S. resident alien for tax purposes.

If you are a U.S. resident alien who is relying on an exception contained in the saving clause of a tax treaty to claim an exemption from U.S. tax on certain types of income, you must attach a statement to Form W-9 that specifies the following five items.

1. The treaty country. Generally, this must be the same treaty under which you claimed exemption from tax as a nonresident alien.
2. The treaty article addressing the income.
3. The article number (or location) in the tax treaty that contains the saving clause and its exceptions.
4. The type and amount of income that qualifies for the exemption from tax.
5. Sufficient facts to justify the exemption from tax under the terms of the treaty article.

Example. Article 20 of the U.S.-China income tax treaty allows an exemption from tax for scholarship income received by a Chinese student temporarily present in the United States. Under U.S. law, this student will become a resident alien for tax purposes if their stay in the United States exceeds 5 calendar years. However, paragraph 2 of the first Protocol to the U.S.-China treaty (dated April 30, 1984) allows the provisions of Article 20 to continue to apply even after the Chinese student becomes a resident alien of the United States. A Chinese student who qualifies for this exception (under paragraph 2 of the first Protocol) and is relying on this exception to claim an exemption from tax on their scholarship or fellowship income would attach to Form W-9 a statement that includes the information described above to support that exemption.

If you are a nonresident alien or a foreign entity, give the requester the appropriate completed Form W-8 or Form 8233.

Backup Withholding

What is backup withholding? Persons making certain payments to you must under certain conditions withhold and pay to the IRS 24% of such payments. This is called “backup withholding.” Payments that may be subject to backup withholding include, but are not limited to, interest, tax-exempt interest, dividends, broker and barter exchange transactions, rents, royalties, nonemployee pay, payments made in settlement of payment card and third-party network transactions, and certain payments from fishing boat operators. Real estate transactions are not subject to backup withholding.

You will not be subject to backup withholding on payments you receive if you give the requester your correct TIN, make the proper certifications, and report all your taxable interest and dividends on your tax return.

Payments you receive will be subject to backup withholding if:

1. You do not furnish your TIN to the requester;
2. You do not certify your TIN when required (see the instructions for Part II for details);
3. The IRS tells the requester that you furnished an incorrect TIN;
4. The IRS tells you that you are subject to backup withholding because you did not report all your interest and dividends on your tax return (for reportable interest and dividends only); or
5. You do not certify to the requester that you are not subject to backup withholding, as described in item 4 under “*By signing the filled-out form*” above (for reportable interest and dividend accounts opened after 1983 only).

Certain payees and payments are exempt from backup withholding. See *Exempt payee code*, later, and the separate Instructions for the Requester of Form W-9 for more information.

See also *Establishing U.S. status for purposes of chapter 3 and chapter 4 withholding*, earlier.

What Is FATCA Reporting?

The Foreign Account Tax Compliance Act (FATCA) requires a participating foreign financial institution to report all U.S. account holders that are specified U.S. persons. Certain payees are exempt from FATCA reporting. See *Exemption from FATCA reporting code*, later, and the Instructions for the Requester of Form W-9 for more information.

Updating Your Information

You must provide updated information to any person to whom you claimed to be an exempt payee if you are no longer an exempt payee and anticipate receiving reportable payments in the future from this person. For example, you may need to provide updated information if you are a C corporation that elects to be an S corporation, or if you are no longer tax exempt. In addition, you must furnish a new Form W-9 if the name or TIN changes for the account, for example, if the grantor of a grantor trust dies.

Penalties

Failure to furnish TIN. If you fail to furnish your correct TIN to a requester, you are subject to a penalty of \$50 for each such failure unless your failure is due to reasonable cause and not to willful neglect.

Civil penalty for false information with respect to withholding. If you make a false statement with no reasonable basis that results in no backup withholding, you are subject to a \$500 penalty.

Criminal penalty for falsifying information. Willfully falsifying certifications or affirmations may subject you to criminal penalties including fines and/or imprisonment.

Misuse of TINs. If the requester discloses or uses TINs in violation of federal law, the requester may be subject to civil and criminal penalties.

Specific Instructions

Line 1

You must enter one of the following on this line; **do not** leave this line blank. The name should match the name on your tax return.

If this Form W-9 is for a joint account (other than an account maintained by a foreign financial institution (FFI)), list first, and then circle, the name of the person or entity whose number you entered in Part I of Form W-9. If you are providing Form W-9 to an FFI to document a joint account, each holder of the account that is a U.S. person must provide a Form W-9.

• **Individual.** Generally, enter the name shown on your tax return. If you have changed your last name without informing the Social Security Administration (SSA) of the name change, enter your first name, the last name as shown on your social security card, and your new last name.

Note for ITIN applicant: Enter your individual name as it was entered on your Form W-7 application, line 1a. This should also be the same as the name you entered on the Form 1040 you filed with your application.

• **Sole proprietor.** Enter your individual name as shown on your Form 1040 on line 1. Enter your business, trade, or “doing business as” (DBA) name on line 2.

• **Partnership, C corporation, S corporation, or LLC, other than a disregarded entity.** Enter the entity’s name as shown on the entity’s tax return on line 1 and any business, trade, or DBA name on line 2.

• **Other entities.** Enter your name as shown on required U.S. federal tax documents on line 1. This name should match the name shown on the charter or other legal document creating the entity. Enter any business, trade, or DBA name on line 2.

• **Disregarded entity.** In general, a business entity that has a single owner, including an LLC, and is not a corporation, is disregarded as an entity separate from its owner (a disregarded entity). See Regulations section 301.7701-2(c)(2). A disregarded entity should check the appropriate box for the tax classification of its owner. Enter the owner’s name on line 1. The name of the owner entered on line 1 should never be a disregarded entity. The name on line 1 should be the name shown on the income tax return on which the income should be reported. For

example, if a foreign LLC that is treated as a disregarded entity for U.S. federal tax purposes has a single owner that is a U.S. person, the U.S. owner’s name is required to be provided on line 1. If the direct owner of the entity is also a disregarded entity, enter the first owner that is not disregarded for federal tax purposes. Enter the disregarded entity’s name on line 2. If the owner of the disregarded entity is a foreign person, the owner must complete an appropriate Form W-8 instead of a Form W-9. This is the case even if the foreign person has a U.S. TIN.

Line 2

If you have a business name, trade name, DBA name, or disregarded entity name, enter it on line 2.

Line 3a

Check the appropriate box on line 3a for the U.S. federal tax classification of the person whose name is entered on line 1. Check only one box on line 3a.

IF the entity/individual on line 1 is a(n) . . .	THEN check the box for . . .
• Corporation	Corporation.
• Individual or • Sole proprietorship	Individual/sole proprietor.
• LLC classified as a partnership for U.S. federal tax purposes or • LLC that has filed Form 8832 or 2553 electing to be taxed as a corporation	Limited liability company and enter the appropriate tax classification: P = Partnership, C = C corporation, or S = S corporation.
• Partnership	Partnership.
• Trust/estate	Trust/estate.

Line 3b

Check this box if you are a partnership (including an LLC classified as a partnership for U.S. federal tax purposes), trust, or estate that has any foreign partners, owners, or beneficiaries, and you are providing this form to a partnership, trust, or estate, in which you have an ownership interest. You must check the box on line 3b if you receive a Form W-8 (or documentary evidence) from any partner, owner, or beneficiary establishing foreign status or if you receive a Form W-9 from any partner, owner, or beneficiary that has checked the box on line 3b.

Note: A partnership that provides a Form W-9 and checks box 3b may be required to complete Schedules K-2 and K-3 (Form 1065). For more information, see the Partnership Instructions for Schedules K-2 and K-3 (Form 1065).

If you are required to complete line 3b but fail to do so, you may not receive the information necessary to file a correct information return with the IRS or furnish a correct payee statement to your partners or beneficiaries. See, for example, sections 6698, 6722, and 6724 for penalties that may apply.

Line 4 Exemptions

If you are exempt from backup withholding and/or FATCA reporting, enter in the appropriate space on line 4 any code(s) that may apply to you.

Exempt payee code.

- Generally, individuals (including sole proprietors) are not exempt from backup withholding.
- Except as provided below, corporations are exempt from backup withholding for certain payments, including interest and dividends.
- Corporations are not exempt from backup withholding for payments made in settlement of payment card or third-party network transactions.
- Corporations are not exempt from backup withholding with respect to attorneys’ fees or gross proceeds paid to attorneys, and corporations that provide medical or health care services are not exempt with respect to payments reportable on Form 1099-MISC.

The following codes identify payees that are exempt from backup withholding. Enter the appropriate code in the space on line 4.

1—An organization exempt from tax under section 501(a), any IRA, or a custodial account under section 403(b)(7) if the account satisfies the requirements of section 401(f)(2).

- 2—The United States or any of its agencies or instrumentalities.
- 3—A state, the District of Columbia, a U.S. commonwealth or territory, or any of their political subdivisions or instrumentalities.
- 4—A foreign government or any of its political subdivisions, agencies, or instrumentalities.
- 5—A corporation.
- 6—A dealer in securities or commodities required to register in the United States, the District of Columbia, or a U.S. commonwealth or territory.
- 7—A futures commission merchant registered with the Commodity Futures Trading Commission.
- 8—A real estate investment trust.
- 9—An entity registered at all times during the tax year under the Investment Company Act of 1940.
- 10—A common trust fund operated by a bank under section 584(a).
- 11—A financial institution as defined under section 581.
- 12—A middleman known in the investment community as a nominee or custodian.
- 13—A trust exempt from tax under section 664 or described in section 4947.

The following chart shows types of payments that may be exempt from backup withholding. The chart applies to the exempt payees listed above, 1 through 13.

IF the payment is for . . .	THEN the payment is exempt for . . .
• Interest and dividend payments	All exempt payees except for 7.
• Broker transactions	Exempt payees 1 through 4 and 6 through 11 and all C corporations. S corporations must not enter an exempt payee code because they are exempt only for sales of noncovered securities acquired prior to 2012.
• Barter exchange transactions and patronage dividends	Exempt payees 1 through 4.
• Payments over \$600 required to be reported and direct sales over \$5,000 ¹	Generally, exempt payees 1 through 5. ²
• Payments made in settlement of payment card or third-party network transactions	Exempt payees 1 through 4.

¹ See Form 1099-MISC, Miscellaneous Information, and its instructions.

² However, the following payments made to a corporation and reportable on Form 1099-MISC are not exempt from backup withholding: medical and health care payments, attorneys' fees, gross proceeds paid to an attorney reportable under section 6045(f), and payments for services paid by a federal executive agency.

Exemption from FATCA reporting code. The following codes identify payees that are exempt from reporting under FATCA. These codes apply to persons submitting this form for accounts maintained outside of the United States by certain foreign financial institutions. Therefore, if you are only submitting this form for an account you hold in the United States, you may leave this field blank. Consult with the person requesting this form if you are uncertain if the financial institution is subject to these requirements. A requester may indicate that a code is not required by providing you with a Form W-9 with "Not Applicable" (or any similar indication) entered on the line for a FATCA exemption code.

A—An organization exempt from tax under section 501(a) or any individual retirement plan as defined in section 7701(a)(37).

B—The United States or any of its agencies or instrumentalities.

C—A state, the District of Columbia, a U.S. commonwealth or territory, or any of their political subdivisions or instrumentalities.

D—A corporation the stock of which is regularly traded on one or more established securities markets, as described in Regulations section 1.1472-1(c)(1)(i).

E—A corporation that is a member of the same expanded affiliated group as a corporation described in Regulations section 1.1472-1(c)(1)(i).

F—A dealer in securities, commodities, or derivative financial instruments (including notional principal contracts, futures, forwards, and options) that is registered as such under the laws of the United States or any state.

G—A real estate investment trust.

H—A regulated investment company as defined in section 851 or an entity registered at all times during the tax year under the Investment Company Act of 1940.

I—A common trust fund as defined in section 584(a).

J—A bank as defined in section 581.

K—A broker.

L—A trust exempt from tax under section 664 or described in section 4947(a)(1).

M—A tax-exempt trust under a section 403(b) plan or section 457(g) plan.

Note: You may wish to consult with the financial institution requesting this form to determine whether the FATCA code and/or exempt payee code should be completed.

Line 5

Enter your address (number, street, and apartment or suite number). This is where the requester of this Form W-9 will mail your information returns. If this address differs from the one the requester already has on file, enter "NEW" at the top. If a new address is provided, there is still a chance the old address will be used until the payor changes your address in their records.

Line 6

Enter your city, state, and ZIP code.

Part I. Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)

Enter your TIN in the appropriate box. If you are a resident alien and you do not have, and are not eligible to get, an SSN, your TIN is your IRS ITIN. Enter it in the entry space for the Social security number. If you do not have an ITIN, see *How to get a TIN* below.

If you are a sole proprietor and you have an EIN, you may enter either your SSN or EIN.

If you are a single-member LLC that is disregarded as an entity separate from its owner, enter the owner's SSN (or EIN, if the owner has one). If the LLC is classified as a corporation or partnership, enter the entity's EIN.

Note: See *What Name and Number To Give the Requester*, later, for further clarification of name and TIN combinations.

How to get a TIN. If you do not have a TIN, apply for one immediately. To apply for an SSN, get Form SS-5, Application for a Social Security Card, from your local SSA office or get this form online at www.SSA.gov. You may also get this form by calling 800-772-1213. Use Form W-7, Application for IRS Individual Taxpayer Identification Number, to apply for an ITIN, or Form SS-4, Application for Employer Identification Number, to apply for an EIN. You can apply for an EIN online by accessing the IRS website at www.irs.gov/EIN. Go to www.irs.gov/Forms to view, download, or print Form W-7 and/or Form SS-4. Or, you can go to www.irs.gov/OrderForms to place an order and have Form W-7 and/or Form SS-4 mailed to you within 15 business days.

If you are asked to complete Form W-9 but do not have a TIN, apply for a TIN and enter "Applied For" in the space for the TIN, sign and date the form, and give it to the requester. For interest and dividend payments, and certain payments made with respect to readily tradable instruments, you will generally have 60 days to get a TIN and give it to the requester before you are subject to backup withholding on payments. The 60-day rule does not apply to other types of payments. You will be subject to backup withholding on all such payments until you provide your TIN to the requester.

Note: Entering "Applied For" means that you have already applied for a TIN or that you intend to apply for one soon. See also *Establishing U.S. status for purposes of chapter 3 and chapter 4 withholding*, earlier, for when you may instead be subject to withholding under chapter 3 or 4 of the Code.

Caution: A disregarded U.S. entity that has a foreign owner must use the appropriate Form W-8.

Part II. Certification

To establish to the withholding agent that you are a U.S. person, or resident alien, sign Form W-9. You may be requested to sign by the withholding agent even if item 1, 4, or 5 below indicates otherwise.

For a joint account, only the person whose TIN is shown in Part I should sign (when required). In the case of a disregarded entity, the person identified on line 1 must sign. Exempt payees, see *Exempt payee code*, earlier.

Signature requirements. Complete the certification as indicated in items 1 through 5 below.

1. Interest, dividend, and barter exchange accounts opened before 1984 and broker accounts considered active during 1983. You must give your correct TIN, but you do not have to sign the certification.

2. Interest, dividend, broker, and barter exchange accounts opened after 1983 and broker accounts considered inactive during 1983. You must sign the certification or backup withholding will apply. If you are subject to backup withholding and you are merely providing your correct TIN to the requester, you must cross out item 2 in the certification before signing the form.

3. Real estate transactions. You must sign the certification. You may cross out item 2 of the certification.

4. Other payments. You must give your correct TIN, but you do not have to sign the certification unless you have been notified that you have previously given an incorrect TIN. "Other payments" include payments made in the course of the requester's trade or business for rents, royalties, goods (other than bills for merchandise), medical and health care services (including payments to corporations), payments to a nonemployee for services, payments made in settlement of payment card and third-party network transactions, payments to certain fishing boat crew members and fishermen, and gross proceeds paid to attorneys (including payments to corporations).

5. Mortgage interest paid by you, acquisition or abandonment of secured property, cancellation of debt, qualified tuition program payments (under section 529), ABLE accounts (under section 529A), IRA, Coverdell ESA, Archer MSA or HSA contributions or distributions, and pension distributions. You must give your correct TIN, but you do not have to sign the certification.

What Name and Number To Give the Requester

For this type of account:	Give name and SSN of:
1. Individual	The individual
2. Two or more individuals (joint account) other than an account maintained by an FFI	The actual owner of the account or, if combined funds, the first individual on the account ¹
3. Two or more U.S. persons (joint account maintained by an FFI)	Each holder of the account
4. Custodial account of a minor (Uniform Gift to Minors Act)	The minor ²
5. a. The usual revocable savings trust (grantor is also trustee)	The grantor-trustee ¹
b. So-called trust account that is not a legal or valid trust under state law	The actual owner ¹
6. Sole proprietorship or disregarded entity owned by an individual	The owner ³
7. Grantor trust filing under Optional Filing Method 1 (see Regulations section 1.671-4(b)(2)(i)(A))**	The grantor*

For this type of account:	Give name and EIN of:
8. Disregarded entity not owned by an individual	The owner
9. A valid trust, estate, or pension trust	Legal entity ⁴
10. Corporation or LLC electing corporate status on Form 8832 or Form 2553	The corporation
11. Association, club, religious, charitable, educational, or other tax-exempt organization	The organization
12. Partnership or multi-member LLC	The partnership
13. A broker or registered nominee	The broker or nominee
14. Account with the Department of Agriculture in the name of a public entity (such as a state or local government, school district, or prison) that receives agricultural program payments	The public entity
15. Grantor trust filing Form 1041 or under the Optional Filing Method 2, requiring Form 1099 (see Regulations section 1.671-4(b)(2)(i)(B))**	The trust

¹ List first and circle the name of the person whose number you furnish. If only one person on a joint account has an SSN, that person's number must be furnished.

² Circle the minor's name and furnish the minor's SSN.

³ You must show your individual name on line 1, and enter your business or DBA name, if any, on line 2. You may use either your SSN or EIN (if you have one), but the IRS encourages you to use your SSN.

⁴ List first and circle the name of the trust, estate, or pension trust. (Do not furnish the TIN of the personal representative or trustee unless the legal entity itself is not designated in the account title.)

* **Note:** The grantor must also provide a Form W-9 to the trustee of the trust.

** For more information on optional filing methods for grantor trusts, see the Instructions for Form 1041.

Note: If no name is circled when more than one name is listed, the number will be considered to be that of the first name listed.

Secure Your Tax Records From Identity Theft

Identity theft occurs when someone uses your personal information, such as your name, SSN, or other identifying information, without your permission to commit fraud or other crimes. An identity thief may use your SSN to get a job or may file a tax return using your SSN to receive a refund.

To reduce your risk:

- Protect your SSN,
- Ensure your employer is protecting your SSN, and
- Be careful when choosing a tax return preparer.

If your tax records are affected by identity theft and you receive a notice from the IRS, respond right away to the name and phone number printed on the IRS notice or letter.

If your tax records are not currently affected by identity theft but you think you are at risk due to a lost or stolen purse or wallet, questionable credit card activity, or a questionable credit report, contact the IRS Identity Theft Hotline at 800-908-4490 or submit Form 14039.

For more information, see Pub. 5027, Identity Theft Information for Taxpayers.

Victims of identity theft who are experiencing economic harm or a systemic problem, or are seeking help in resolving tax problems that have not been resolved through normal channels, may be eligible for Taxpayer Advocate Service (TAS) assistance. You can reach TAS by calling the TAS toll-free case intake line at 877-777-4778 or TTY/TDD 800-829-4059.

Protect yourself from suspicious emails or phishing schemes.

Phishing is the creation and use of email and websites designed to mimic legitimate business emails and websites. The most common act is sending an email to a user falsely claiming to be an established legitimate enterprise in an attempt to scam the user into surrendering private information that will be used for identity theft.

The IRS does not initiate contacts with taxpayers via emails. Also, the IRS does not request personal detailed information through email or ask taxpayers for the PIN numbers, passwords, or similar secret access information for their credit card, bank, or other financial accounts.

If you receive an unsolicited email claiming to be from the IRS, forward this message to phishing@irs.gov. You may also report misuse of the IRS name, logo, or other IRS property to the Treasury Inspector General for Tax Administration (TIGTA) at 800-366-4484. You can forward suspicious emails to the Federal Trade Commission at spam@uce.gov or report them at www.ftc.gov/complaint. You can contact the FTC at www.ftc.gov/idtheft or 877-IDTHEFT (877-438-4338). If you have been the victim of identity theft, see www.IdentityTheft.gov and Pub. 5027.

Go to www.irs.gov/IdentityTheft to learn more about identity theft and how to reduce your risk.

Privacy Act Notice

Section 6109 of the Internal Revenue Code requires you to provide your correct TIN to persons (including federal agencies) who are required to file information returns with the IRS to report interest, dividends, or certain other income paid to you; mortgage interest you paid; the acquisition or abandonment of secured property; the cancellation of debt; or contributions you made to an IRA, Archer MSA, or HSA. The person collecting this form uses the information on the form to file information returns with the IRS, reporting the above information. Routine uses of this information include giving it to the Department of Justice for civil and criminal litigation and to cities, states, the District of Columbia, and U.S. commonwealths and territories for use in administering their laws. The information may also be disclosed to other countries under a treaty, to federal and state agencies to enforce civil and criminal laws, or to federal law enforcement and intelligence agencies to combat terrorism. You must provide your TIN whether or not you are required to file a tax return. Under section 3406, payors must generally withhold a percentage of taxable interest, dividends, and certain other payments to a payee who does not give a TIN to the payor. Certain penalties may also apply for providing false or fraudulent information.